JAMES M. GAVIN
TOP 3 LEGENDARY TACTICAL MOVES

Publishing guide: everything you need to upload the finished video



Main thumbnail: CROSS THE RIVER (battlefield made with vidIQ; Gavin's real public-domain US Army photo added on top)

1. The finished video

Item	Details
File	1-Gavin-Top3-FINAL-1080p.mp4 (1920x1080, 30 fps, H.264 + AAC, 559 MB)
Download	https://gofile.io/d/qRIDiufh
Length	14:01
Voice	Kokoro (free AI voice, am_michael)
Music	Kevin MacLeod, 4 tracks, CC BY 4.0, ducked under the voice (locked level 0.08)
Sound effects	The channel's locked kit: Freesound recordings (CC BY / CC0), Mixkit zoom sound, original effects

Chapters

Starts	Chapter
0:00	Intro: 26 boats
1:53	Move 1: Biazza Ridge
5:58	Move 2: The La Fiere Causeway
9:31	Move 3: The Waal Crossing
13:16	Legacy

Key frames



2. Title

Final title (copy and paste)

James Gavin's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Took the Nijmegen Bridge

Why it follows the rules (HANDOVER section 10, PACKAGING_GUIDE section 2): the Tactical Genius pattern *name's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who ...*; the subtitle is a big, well-known, true result (the Nijmegen bridge); the new hook says it in the first 10 seconds ("before dark, they took the bridge"); no nicknames, no "fired / almost" angle, no negation; 84 characters (limit 100). vidIQ score 89.

Alternatives, all scored with vidIQ (switch only if you prefer one):

- James Gavin's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The General Who Fought Like a Private (91)
- James Gavin's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Jumped Into Four Battles (90)
- James Gavin's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Crossed the Waal (87)

Rejected: "The Man Who Stopped the Tigers" (89): one ridge is not a huge result and it overstates; "Paratroopers vs Tiger Tanks: ..." (93): not the Tactical Genius pattern.

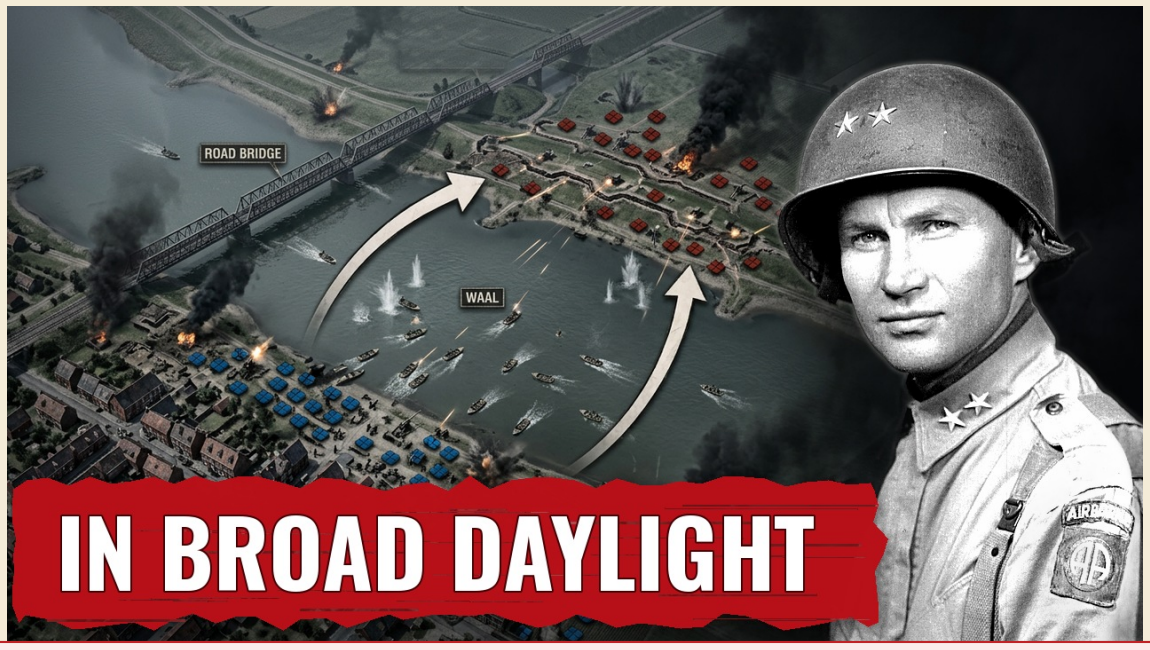
3. Thumbnails

Same formula as every Tactical Genius thumbnail: a dark, grey aerial battlefield with red/blue unit blocks and big white arrows on the left two-thirds, the commander's portrait on the right third, a rough red brush-stroke banner bottom-left, and 1-3 words that make sense with zero context. The scene is the Waal crossing, the same scene as the hook and the title promise (Nijmegen bridge).

A: CROSS THE RIVER (main, type 1: the hero's decision)



B: IN BROAD DAYLIGHT (alternative for YouTube's Test & compare, type 3: ominous stakes)



Checked: the battlefield was generated by vidIQ from the real Tactical Genius thumbnails as references; it shows the Waal, the road bridge, canvas boats under fire, blue paratroopers on the south bank and red Germans on the north bank. I removed an ambiguous second bridge label and replaced the AI face on the small GAVIN map tag with his real photo. The portrait is Gavin's real US Army photo (public domain), not an AI likeness; the helmet shows two stars, correct for September 1944 (major general). The face has extra contrast and a faint light edge (face-pop rule), with no glow. Both read at phone size (168x94).

4. Description (copy and paste)

The first line is the title. Everything after it is the description: ready to paste, with NO links (channel rule). Keep the credit lines: the music, sound and image licences require them. Chapters are from the final timing.

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James Gavin's Top 3 Legendary Tactical Moves | The Man Who Took the Nijmegen Bridge

Twenty-six canvas boats. Two hundred and sixty men. A river three hundred metres wide, in broad
daylight, with German guns waiting on the far bank. The general who sent them had done this kind of
thing before.

In this video we break down James Gavin's three greatest tactical moves: the stand on Biazza Ridge
against Tiger tanks in Sicily (1943), the charge across the La Fière causeway in Normandy (1944),
and the Waal River crossing at Nijmegen during Operation Market Garden (1944).

Lead from the front. Take the ground that decides the battle. Attack where the enemy is sure you
cannot.

Which was Gavin's greatest move: Biazza Ridge, La Fière, or the Waal crossing? Tell us in the
comments. And if someone in your family served in the Second World War, tell us their story.

CHAPTERS
0:00 Intro: 26 Canvas Boats
0:52 Who Was James Gavin?
1:53 Move 1: Biazza Ridge
3:20 Paratroopers vs Tiger Tanks
5:58 Move 2: The La Fiere Causeway
7:58 9 June: The Charge Across the Causeway
9:31 Move 3: Market Garden
11:31 The Waal Crossing
13:16 Legacy

SOURCES
James M. Gavin, "Jump into Sicily" (account of Biazza Ridge, American Heritage) and On to Berlin:
Battles of an Airborne Commander 1943-1946 (1978)
Albert N. Garland & Howard McGaw Smyth, Sicily and the Surrender of Italy (US Army Center of
Military History)
Utah Beach to Cherbourg (US Army, American Forces in Action series)
Phil Nordyke, All American All the Way: The Combat History of the 82nd Airborne Division in World
War II
Cornelius Ryan, A Bridge Too Far (1974)
Charles B. MacDonald, The Siegfried Line Campaign (US Army Center of Military History)

CREDITS
Maps: original animations; terrain from Mapzen / AWS Terrain Tiles (open data).

Music by Kevin MacLeod (incompetech): "Long Note One", "Wounded", "Long Note Two", "Anguish".
Licensed under Creative Commons: By Attribution 4.0 License.

Sound effects: "artillery distance" by 2887679652 (CC BY 4.0), "Cannon Artillery distant gunshots"
by Aegersum (CC BY 3.0), "Distant explosion" by juskiddink (CC BY 4.0), "Distant explosions" by
Kostrava (CC0), via Freesound. Zoom sound: Mixkit (Mixkit Sound Effects Free License). Other sound
effects: original.

Archival film: public domain (US National Archives: Army Signal Corps films and Army Combat
Bulletins, US Navy films, Office of War Information "United News" newsreels, Universal Newsreels,
Army Air Forces "D-Day Minus One"), via the Internet Archive.

Images: public domain (US Army Signal Corps, US Army Military History Institute, US Department of
Defense, Library of Congress / Alfred T. Palmer, JFK Library / Abbie Rowe), via Wikimedia Commons
and the Library of Congress.

Narration voice: AI-generated (Kokoro TTS). Maps: original animations.
Business enquiries: [email to fill in]

#JamesGavin #82ndAirborne #MilitaryHistory
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5. Tags and upload settings

Setting	Value
Tags (paste all)	military history, history documentary, World War II, WW2, James Gavin, James M. Gavin, 82nd Airborne Division, paratroopers, Battle of Biazza Ridge, Operation Husky, La Fiere causeway, Normandy, D-Day, Operation Market Garden, Waal crossing, Nijmegen, greatest military tactics, animated battle map
Category	Education
Audience	Not made for kids
Language / captions	English; let YouTube auto-caption, then check the names (Nijmegen, Waal, Biazza, Ponte Dirillo, La Fière, Merderet, Cauquigny, Julian Cook)
Altered or synthetic content	Yes: the narration is an AI voice and the thumbnail battlefield is AI-generated. Tick the disclosure box.
Chapters	Automatic from the description (first chapter is 0:00)
Schedule	Your audience's peak time (YouTube Studio > Analytics > Audience)

6. After uploading

Pinned comment (paste and pin)

So which was Gavin's greatest move? 1) Biazza Ridge 2) La Fière 3) the Waal crossing. Tell us below. And if someone in your family served in the Second World War, on either side, tell us their story. We read every one.

End screen (the last ~20 seconds keep the map on screen)

The ending names the next video: Rokossovsky. When that video is public, set it as the end-screen video and add the Subscribe element in YouTube Studio. Until then use "Best for viewer".

Upload checklist

- Play the 1080p master through once (sound, sync, no black frames).
- Upload the master.
- Paste title, description and tags; upload thumbnail A (1280x720); add thumbnail B in Test & compare.
- Fill in the business email in the description.
- Tick 'altered or synthetic content'.
- Add end screen and cards; set visibility and schedule; pin the comment above.
- After 24-48 h: check click-through rate and 30-second retention. Targets: CTR 4% or more, 65% at 0:30, 55% at 1:00, ending loss 3 points or less. If CTR is under 2% after about 1,000 impressions, change the title first, then the thumbnail.

Facts to double-check before publishing (single secondary source or disputed; see research/FACT_NOTES.md):
• "No other American general made four combat jumps" (Wikipedia wording; the new hook says only "four combat jumps in fourteen months").
• Gavin to Capt. Rae, "All right, you've got to go." (HistoryNet; shown in quote marks).
• Julian Cook praying "Hail Mary, full of grace" while paddling (Ryan / secondary sources).
• "None of the paratroopers had ever used one" (the canvas boats).
• Orphan, private at 17, little schooling, a general who carried a rifle (Gemini research, also in the earlier script).

• Biazza Ridge casualties: Gavin's own count (about 50 dead, 100+ wounded); the Ponte Dirillo memorial lists 39 names.
• Waal crossing: 48 killed, only about half the boats reached the far bank (Gemini research); wounded shown as 100+ (sources give ~100 to 151).
• Map positions (Biazza Ridge crest, the La Fière flood edge, the crossing point) are approximate, read from terrain.